

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES

Leave and Attendance Policy

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Section numbering in this document is stable across versions. Where a clause has been withdrawn the number is retained and marked withdrawn, so that cross-references from other policies continue to resolve.

1. Purpose, Scope and Principles

1.1 Purpose

This Policy establishes a single, uniform framework for leave entitlement, leave administration, attendance recording and absence management across Nexora Technologies Private Limited. It replaces all earlier location-specific practices, including the separate Bengaluru attendance addendum of March 2019 and the Pune shift-attendance note of July 2022, both of which stand withdrawn with effect from 1 January 2026.

1.2 Scope

This Policy applies to all employees on the Nexora payroll, including probationers, Graduate Engineer Trainees after deployment, and fixed-term contract employees. It does not apply to interns engaged for fewer than ninety (90) days, to independent contractors, or to staffing-partner deputies, whose absence arrangements are governed by their own contracts.

Where a provision of this Policy is less favourable than a mandatory requirement of the Shops and Commercial Establishments legislation of Haryana, Karnataka or Maharashtra, or of any other applicable statute, the statutory provision prevails to the extent of the shortfall, and the HR Operations team will apply the statutory position without requiring an application from the employee.

1.3 Governing Principles

1. **Leave is planned.** Except for sickness and genuine emergency, leave is applied for and approved before it is taken.
2. **Leave is an entitlement, not a favour.** A manager may decline leave only for a documented business reason and must offer an alternative window.
3. **Attendance is a record, not a surveillance instrument.** Attendance data is used for payroll, statutory registers, client billing and capacity planning. It is not used to evaluate individual performance in isolation.
4. **Rest is not optional.** Managers are accountable for ensuring that their team members take leave. An employee carrying more than twenty-five (25) days of unused Earned Leave on 30 September triggers an alert to the manager and the HRBP.

1.4 The Leave Year

The Nexora leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**. It deliberately differs from the financial year (1 April to 31 March) and from the performance year (1 April to 31 March). Leave balances, carry-forward, lapse and encashment are all calculated on the calendar year.

2. Leave Entitlements

2.1 Summary of Entitlements

#	Leave type	Code	Annual entitlement	Credited	Carry forward	Encashable
1	Casual Leave	CL	12 days	3 days on 1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul, 1 Oct	No	No
2	Sick Leave	SL	12 days	12 days on 1 January	No	No
3	Earned Leave	EL	18 days	1.5 days per completed calendar month	Up to 30 days	Yes
4	Compensatory Off	CO	As earned	On approved holiday/weekly-off work	No	No
5	Maternity Leave	ML	26 weeks	On application	Not applicable	Not applicable
6	Paternity Leave	PL	10 working days	On application	Not applicable	Not applicable
7	Adoption Leave	AL	12 weeks	On application	Not applicable	Not applicable
8	Bereavement Leave	BL	5 calendar days per event	On application	Not applicable	Not applicable
9	Marriage Leave	MRL	5 working days, once in tenure	On application	Not applicable	Not applicable
10	Loss of Pay	LOP	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable
11	Sabbatical	SAB	Up to 6 months, unpaid	On approval	Not applicable	Not applicable
12	Special Leave	SPL	At Company discretion	On approval	Not applicable	Not applicable

Total paid annual leave for a confirmed employee: 42 days (12 CL + 12 SL + 18 EL), exclusive of public holidays and statutory parental leave.

2.2 Pro-rata Entitlement in the Year of Joining

Casual Leave and Sick Leave are credited pro rata from the month of joining. Earned Leave accrues from the first completed calendar month of service. The joining-date rule is:

Date of joining in a month	Credit for that month
1st to 15th	Full month credited
16th to end of month	No credit for that month; accrual begins the following month

Worked example: an employee joining on 12 August 2026 is credited 1.25 days of CL and 1.25 days of SL for August, plus the pro-rated balance for the remainder of the year, giving 5 days of CL and 5 days of SL for the period August to December 2026. Earned Leave accrues at 1.5 days for each of August, September, October, November and December, giving 7.5 days, rounded up to 8 days at the 31 December closing.

A second worked example: an employee joining on 20 August 2026 receives no credit for August. CL and SL are credited at 1 day per month for September to December, giving 4 days each, and Earned Leave accrues 6 days.

2.3 Rounding

All balances are maintained to two decimal places in PeopleHub and are rounded to the nearest half-day only at the point of application. A balance of 0.25 day or less cannot be applied and is carried in the ledger until it accumulates.

3. Casual Leave (CL)

3.1 Purpose and Quantum

Casual Leave covers short, unplanned personal absences: a domestic emergency, a civic appointment, a school event, a vehicle breakdown, a religious observance not covered by the holiday calendar. The entitlement is twelve (12) days per leave year, credited three (3) days on the first day of each quarter.

3.2 Rules

1. Casual Leave may be taken in units of half a day or one full day.
2. Not more than **three (3) consecutive days** of Casual Leave may be taken at one time.

An absence longer than three days must be applied as Earned Leave.

3. Casual Leave may not be combined with Earned Leave in a single continuous absence, except

where the Casual Leave is the first or last day of the absence and the total absence does not exceed five (5) days.

4. Casual Leave may be prefixed or suffixed to a weekly off or a public holiday. Intervening

weekly offs and holidays are not counted against the Casual Leave balance.

5. Unused Casual Leave lapses on 31 December. It is not carried forward and is not

encashable, on separation or otherwise.

6. Casual Leave credited for a quarter that has not yet begun may not be availed in advance.

3.3 Notice

Casual Leave requires a minimum of one (1) working day's advance notice on PeopleHub. Where the circumstances make advance notice impossible, the employee must inform the reporting manager by telephone or message before 10:00 IST on the day of absence and must regularise the application on PeopleHub on the first working day after return.

4. Sick Leave (SL)

4.1 Purpose and Quantum

Sick Leave covers absence caused by the employee's own illness, injury, medical procedure, or a medically advised period of quarantine or recovery. The entitlement is twelve (12) days per leave year, credited in full on 1 January.

4.2 Rules

1. Sick Leave may be taken in units of half a day or one full day.
2. Sick Leave for **more than two (2) consecutive working days** must be supported by a

medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner, stating the period of advised rest. The certificate is uploaded to PeopleHub within seven (7) calendar days of return.

3. Sick Leave for **more than five (5) consecutive working days** additionally requires a

fitness-to-resume certificate before the employee returns to work.

4. Sick Leave for **more than ten (10) consecutive working days** is reviewed by the HRBP,

who may, with the employee's consent, refer the case to the Company's medical adviser and may convert the balance of the absence to Earned Leave or to Special Leave.

5. Sick Leave may not be applied prospectively except for a scheduled medical procedure, for

which the application may be made in advance with supporting documentation.

6. Sick Leave may be used for the hospitalisation of a spouse, dependent child or dependent

parent, up to a maximum of five (5) days in a leave year, on production of the discharge summary or admission record.

7. Unused Sick Leave lapses on 31 December. It is not carried forward and is not encashable.

4.3 Exhausted Sick Leave

Where an employee's Sick Leave is exhausted, further medical absence is applied against Earned Leave, and thereafter against Casual Leave, and thereafter as Loss of Pay. In cases of serious illness supported by medical documentation, the CHRO may sanction Special Leave on full or half pay for up to sixty (60) days in a leave year.

5. Earned Leave (EL)

5.1 Purpose and Quantum

Earned Leave, also referred to as Privilege Leave, is intended for planned rest and personal commitments requiring an extended absence. The entitlement is eighteen (18) days per leave year, accruing at one and a half (1.5) days for each completed calendar month of service.

5.2 Rules

1. Earned Leave may be taken in units of half a day or one full day. There is no maximum

duration, subject to approval.

2. Earned Leave of three (3) or more consecutive days requires seven (7) calendar days'

advance notice. Earned Leave of five (5) or more consecutive days requires fifteen (15) calendar days' advance notice. Earned Leave of ten (10) or more consecutive days requires thirty (30) calendar days' advance notice and the additional approval of the Delivery Manager and the HRBP.

3. Earned Leave may not be availed in advance of accrual. An employee whose accrued balance

is insufficient may apply for the shortfall as Loss of Pay.

4. Weekly offs and public holidays falling within a period of Earned Leave **are counted**

against the Earned Leave balance where the leave period exceeds five (5) continuous calendar days. For absences of five days or fewer, intervening weekly offs and holidays are not counted.

5. An employee on Earned Leave for fifteen (15) or more continuous days must complete a

documented handover to a named backup, recorded on PeopleHub before the leave begins.

5.3 Carry Forward and Lapse

A maximum of **thirty (30) days** of unused Earned Leave may be carried forward from one leave year to the next. The carry-forward is computed at the 31 December closing.

Any Earned Leave balance in excess of thirty (30) days on 31 December is **automatically encashed** in the January payroll of the following year at the rate of:

$$\text{Encashment per day} = (\text{Monthly Basic Salary} + \text{Dearness Allowance}) \div 30$$

Automatic encashment is a payroll event; no application is required. It is taxable as salary income and is reflected in the payslip under "EL Encashment".

Worked example: an employee with a monthly Basic of INR 62,000 and no Dearness Allowance holds 37 days of Earned Leave on 31 December 2026. Thirty days are carried forward to 2027; seven days are encashed at INR 2,066.67 per day, giving INR 14,466.69, credited in the January 2027 payroll.

5.4 Encashment on Separation

On separation, accrued and unused Earned Leave up to a maximum of thirty (30) days is encashed in the full and final settlement at the rate in Clause 5.3, computed on the last drawn Basic Salary. Earned Leave

in excess of thirty days at the date of separation lapses.

Earned Leave may **not** be adjusted against the notice period. Where an employee takes approved leave during the notice period, the last working day is extended by an equivalent number of calendar days, unless the function head waives the extension in writing.

5.5 Leave Recall

The Company reserves the right to recall an employee from Earned Leave in the event of a declared client emergency or a Severity-1 production incident. Where an employee is recalled:

- (a) the days not availed are re-credited to the leave balance;
- (b) any non-refundable travel or accommodation cost actually incurred by the employee is reimbursed on production of the invoice, up to INR 60,000; and
- (c) the recall must be approved by a Band B6 or above leader and recorded on PeopleHub.

Recall is exceptional. A function recording more than four recalls in a rolling twelve-month period is reviewed by the COO.

6. Compensatory Off (CO)

6.1 Eligibility

A Compensatory Off is credited where an employee, at the documented request of the reporting manager, works on a weekly off or a public holiday. It is not credited for extended hours on a normal working day, nor for voluntary weekend work undertaken without a prior request.

Hours worked on a weekly off or holiday	Compensatory Off credited
4 hours or more but less than 8 hours	0.5 day
8 hours or more	1 day
Less than 4 hours	Nil

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6.2 Rules

1. The manager must raise the Compensatory Off request on PeopleHub **before** the weekend or holiday work, or within three (3) working days after it where the work arose from an unplanned incident.
2. A Compensatory Off must be availed within **sixty (60) days** of the date on which it was earned. An unavailed Compensatory Off lapses at the end of that period and is not encashable under any circumstances.
3. A maximum of six (6) Compensatory Offs may be held in the balance at any time. Where the balance would exceed six, the manager must schedule the employee's time off before approving further weekend work.
4. Compensatory Off may be combined with Casual Leave or Earned Leave.
5. Employees rostered on a shift pattern whose weekly offs fall on days other than Saturday and Sunday earn Compensatory Off in respect of their rostered weekly offs, not in respect of Saturday and Sunday.
6. Compensatory Off is not available to employees at Band B6 and above, whose terms contemplate the flexibility required by the role.

7. Parental and Family Leave

7.1 Maternity Leave

Maternity Leave is granted in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, as amended.

Circumstance	Entitlement
First and second surviving child	26 weeks, of which up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery
Third and subsequent child	12 weeks, of which up to 6 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery
Adoptive mother (child below 3 months at handover)	12 weeks from the date the child is handed over
Commissioning mother	12 weeks from the date the child is handed over
Miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy	6 weeks from the date of the event
Tubectomy	2 weeks from the date of the operation
Illness arising out of pregnancy, delivery, premature birth or termination	An additional 1 month, on medical certificate

Administration. The employee notifies the HRBP and the reporting manager at least eight (8) weeks before the intended start of leave, and uploads the medical certificate stating

the expected date of delivery. Full salary is paid throughout Maternity Leave. Provident Fund, insurance cover and Earned Leave accrual continue without interruption.

Return to work. On return, the employee is entitled to be placed in the same role, or a role of equivalent band, scope and compensation. The employee is entitled to two nursing breaks of fifteen (15) minutes each per day, in addition to the meal break, until the child attains the age of fifteen (15) months.

Work from home after Maternity Leave. The employee may elect to work from home for a further period of up to twelve (12) weeks immediately after Maternity Leave, on full pay, subject to the nature of the work permitting it, in accordance with Section 5(5) of the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961.

Creche. Nexora reimburses creche expenses of up to INR 8,000 per month per child for children up to six (6) years of age, for a maximum of twenty-four (24) months per child. The Bengaluru and Gurugram sites additionally have a tie-up with the Little Orbit creche network within 2 km of the office.

7.2 Paternity Leave

Paternity Leave of **ten (10) working days** is granted to an employee on the birth of a child, or on the legal adoption of a child below the age of three (3) years.

1. Paternity Leave may be taken in a maximum of two blocks, within six (6) months of the date of birth or the date of handover of the adopted child.
2. Paternity Leave is available for up to two children during the employee's tenure with the Company.
3. The application must be supported by the birth certificate or the adoption order, uploaded

to PeopleHub within thirty (30) days of the start of the leave.

4. Paternity Leave is available to all employees irrespective of gender who are the

non-birthing parent, including partners in a same-sex relationship recognised by the employee's nomination on PeopleHub.

7.3 Bereavement Leave

Five (5) calendar days per event, on the death of a spouse, child, parent, parent-in-law, sibling or grandparent. The leave is granted on intimation to the reporting manager; no prior approval is required, and no documentation is demanded, though HR may request a copy of the death certificate where the leave exceeds five days and is extended into Special Leave. Travel time for an employee whose family is in another State may be added by the HRBP up to two (2) additional days.

7.4 Marriage Leave

Five (5) working days, once during the employee's tenure with the Company, on the occasion of the employee's own marriage. The application must be made at least thirty (30) days in advance and must be accompanied by the wedding invitation or, after the event, the marriage certificate.

7.5 Sabbatical

Employees who have completed five (5) years of continuous service may apply for an unpaid sabbatical of up to six (6) months for higher education, care of a dependant, medical recovery, or a defined personal project.

Aspect	Treatment during sabbatical
Salary	Not paid
Group Medclaim, GPA, GTL	Continue; employee bears the premium for the sabbatical months
Provident Fund	No contribution by either party
Earned Leave accrual	Suspended
Gratuity service	Counted as continuous service
Role on return	Same band; specific role subject to availability

Sabbatical requires the approval of the function head and the CHRO, must be applied for at least sixty (60) days in advance, and carries a service commitment of twelve (12) months on return. Not more than 2% of a function's headcount may be on sabbatical at any one time.

8. Attendance

8.1 Working Hours

The standard work week is Monday to Friday, nine (9) hours per day inclusive of a sixty (60) minute meal break, giving forty (40) net working hours per week. Employees may start work at any time between 08:00 and 11:00 IST and must be available during core hours of 11:00 to 17:00 IST.

8.2 Recording

Attendance is recorded through the access-card swipe at the office turnstile and through the PeopleHub check-in, which may be completed from the Nexora network, through the PeopleHub mobile application with location services enabled, or through the VPN client for employees working remotely on an approved day.

Both records must exist for a day to be counted automatically. Where only one exists, the day appears as an exception on the manager's PeopleHub dashboard and must be regularised.

8.3 Day Classification

Net hours	Classification	Payroll effect
8.00 and above	Present — full day	Nil
6.00 to 7.99	Short day	Flagged; three in a month trigger manager review
4.50 to 5.99	Half day	0.5 day leave deducted
Below 4.50	Absent	1 day leave deducted

8.4 Regularisation

Regularisation requests are raised on PeopleHub within seven (7) calendar days of the date in question, with a reason and, where applicable, evidence such as a client meeting invitation or a travel record. A maximum of three (3) regularisations per calendar month is permitted without HRBP approval. The monthly attendance register locks on the 18th for the preceding period; entries after the lock are adjusted in the following month's payroll.

8.5 Late Marks and Early Departure

An arrival after 11:00 IST without a prior approved exception is a late mark. A departure before the completion of net eight hours, other than on approved half-day leave, is an early departure and is treated in the same manner as a late mark.

Late marks / early departures in a calendar month	Consequence
1 to 2	No action
3 to 5	Deduction of 0.5 day Casual Leave
6 to 8	Deduction of 1 day Casual Leave and a counselling note by the manager
More than 8	Attendance deficiency; formal counselling under HR-POL-001, Clause 15.2

Late marks are not recorded for employees on an approved shift roster, on client-site deputation, on approved business travel, on an approved medical appointment, or where the Facilities team has notified a transport disruption, civic emergency, or a weather event affecting the site.

8.6 Minimum Monthly Attendance

An employee must record a minimum of **eighteen (18) attended days** in a calendar month containing twenty-one or more working days, counting approved paid leave as attended, in order for the month to count as a full month for Earned Leave accrual and for variable pay computation. Months containing Maternity Leave, Paternity Leave or a Company-approved sabbatical are excluded from this rule.

9. Public Holidays

9.1 Structure

Nexora publishes an annual holiday calendar by 30 November for the following year. The calendar comprises:

- **Ten (10) fixed holidays** observed at all three locations;
- **One or two regional holidays** specific to each location, reflecting State practice;
- **Two (2) optional holidays** selected by each employee from a published list of eligible dates, declared on PeopleHub by 31 January.

9.2 Rules

1. A fixed or regional holiday that falls on a Saturday or a Sunday is not compensated with

an alternative working-day holiday.

2. Optional holidays must be declared in advance on PeopleHub. An optional holiday not

declared and not taken by 31 December lapses.

3. An employee who works on a fixed or regional holiday at the manager's documented request

earns a Compensatory Off under Clause 6.

4. An employee on deputation to another Nexora location for more than thirty (30) continuous

days observes the holiday calendar of the host location for the duration of the deputation.

5. Employees deputed to a client site observe the Nexora calendar unless the engagement's

Delivery Operating Model records the client's calendar, in which case the total number of holidays must not be fewer than the Nexora entitlement.

9.3 Holiday Calendar 2026 — Fixed Holidays (All Locations)

#	Date	Day	Holiday
1	26 January 2026	Monday	Republic Day
2	4 March 2026	Wednesday	Holi
3	3 April 2026	Friday	Good Friday
4	1 May 2026	Friday	Labour Day
5	15 August 2026	Saturday	Independence Day (falls on a weekly off)
6	2 October 2026	Friday	Gandhi Jayanti
7	20 October 2026	Tuesday	Dussehra
8	9 November 2026	Monday	Diwali — Govardhan Puja
9	10 November 2026	Tuesday	Bhai Dooj
10	25 December 2026	Friday	Christmas Day

9.4 Holiday Calendar 2026 — Regional Holidays

Location	Date	Day	Holiday
Gurugram	24 November 2026	Tuesday	Guru Nanak Jayanti
Bengaluru	14 January 2026	Wednesday	Makar Sankranti / Pongal
Bengaluru	1 November 2026	Sunday	Kannada Rajyotsava (falls on a weekly off)
Pune	19 March 2026	Thursday	Gudi Padwa
Pune	27 May 2026	Wednesday	Bakrid / Eid-ul-Adha

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9.5 Holiday Calendar 2026 — Optional Holidays (Select Any Two)

Date	Day	Holiday
1 January 2026	Thursday	New Year's Day
20 March 2026	Friday	Eid-ul-Fitr
14 April 2026	Tuesday	Dr. B. R. Ambedkar Jayanti
27 May 2026	Wednesday	Bakrid / Eid-ul-Adha (fixed for Pune)
14 September 2026	Monday	Ganesh Chaturthi
24 November 2026	Tuesday	Guru Nanak Jayanti (fixed for Gurugram)
31 December 2026	Thursday	New Year's Eve

10. Leave Administration

10.1 The Application Workflow

Step	Actor	System	Service level
1	Employee raises leave request with dates, type and reason	PeopleHub → My Leave → Apply	—
2	Reporting manager approves, declines with reason, or requests modification	PeopleHub → Team → Approvals	2 working days
3	Second-level approval where required (leave of 10+ days, sabbatical, special leave)	Delivery Manager and HRBP	3 working days
4	Balance updated; calendar and project resource plan updated	PeopleHub, automatic	Immediate on approval
5	Escalation where no action in 2 working days	Auto-escalation to skip-level manager	On day 3

A leave request that receives no decision within five (5) working days is auto-approved by PeopleHub, and the approval is logged against the skip-level manager. Auto-approval does not apply to sabbatical, special leave or leave of more than fifteen (15) days.

10.2 Declining Leave

A manager who declines a leave request must record a business reason in the PeopleHub comment field and must propose at least one alternative window within the following sixty

(60) days. Generic reasons such as "project pressure" are not acceptable; the reason must

identify the specific delivery commitment at risk.

A leave request may not be declined where:

- (a) the request is for Sick Leave supported by a medical certificate;
- (b) the request is for Maternity, Paternity, Adoption, Bereavement or statutory leave;
- (c) the employee has been declined the same window twice previously; or
- (d) declining would cause the employee's Earned Leave balance to exceed the thirty-day carry-forward cap on 31 December.

10.3 Cancellation and Modification

Approved leave may be cancelled by the employee up to the day before the leave begins, directly on PeopleHub. Cancellation of leave already commenced requires manager approval and is effective from the date of return to work. Leave cancelled after the start date is re-credited only for the days not availed.

10.4 Leave During Notice Period

Leave during the notice period requires the approval of the function head in addition to the reporting manager. Approved leave during notice extends the last working day by an equivalent number of calendar days, unless the function head expressly waives the extension in writing on PeopleHub. Casual Leave and Sick Leave credited but unused at the date of resignation may be availed during the notice period subject to this clause; they are not encashable.

10.5 Leave During Probation

Probationers accrue and may avail Casual Leave and Sick Leave from the date of joining. Earned Leave accrues during probation but may be availed only after confirmation, except with the approval of the HRBP in a documented emergency. Leave taken during probation in excess of five (5) days may result in the extension of probation by an equivalent period.

10.6 Records and Retention

Leave records are maintained on PeopleHub and retained for eight (8) years from the end of the leave year, in accordance with the record-retention requirements of the applicable Shops and Commercial Establishments rules. Employees may download their own leave ledger at any time from PeopleHub → My Leave → Ledger.

The statutory leave register in the prescribed form for each State is generated from PeopleHub by HR Operations and is maintained at each site for inspection.

11. Absence Management

11.1 Unauthorised Absence

Absence without an approved leave application and without intimation to the reporting manager is unauthorised absence. It is recorded as Loss of Pay and follows this escalation:

Consecutive working days absent	Action	Owner
1	Manager attempts contact; notes attempt on PeopleHub	Reporting manager
3	Formal contact attempt by email and registered mobile; HRBP informed	Reporting manager
5	Written show-cause notice by email and registered post, requiring response in 7 days	HR Operations
8	Second and final notice; access suspended pending response	HR Operations
10	Deemed voluntary abandonment of service; record closed with effect from day 1	CHRO

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Where an employee provides a satisfactory explanation, the absence may be regularised against available leave balances or as Loss of Pay, at the HRBP's determination.

11.2 Loss of Pay Computation

Loss of Pay is deducted at:

$$LOP \text{ per day} = \text{Monthly Gross Salary} \div \text{Number of calendar days in the month}$$

Loss of Pay affects Provident Fund contribution, which is computed on the reduced Basic Salary for the month, and affects the Earned Leave accrual for that month where the requirement of Clause 8.6 is not met. Loss of Pay of more than five (5) days in a calendar month is reported to the HRBP and reviewed with the manager.

11.3 Absenteeism Patterns

HR Operations reports the following patterns to the HRBP each month for review with the manager. Identification of a pattern is not, by itself, evidence of misconduct; it prompts a supportive conversation first.

1. Casual Leave or Sick Leave adjoining a weekly off or public holiday on three or more

occasions in a rolling quarter.

2. Single-day Sick Leave on a Monday or a Friday on four or more occasions in a rolling

six-month period.

3. Exhaustion of the full Sick Leave entitlement before 30 June.
4. Repeated regularisation requests at the seven-day boundary.

11.4 Extended Medical Absence

An employee absent on medical grounds for more than thirty (30) continuous calendar days is placed on the Extended Medical Absence register maintained by the HRBP. During this period:

- (a) the employee remains on the payroll and retains insurance cover;
- (b) leave balances are applied in the order SL, EL, CL, then Special Leave or Loss of Pay;
- (c) the HRBP maintains fortnightly contact at a frequency agreed with the employee;
- (d) a return-to-work plan, which may include phased hours or temporary role modification for up to eight (8) weeks, is agreed before the return date; and
- (e) reasonable accommodation under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, is considered where the condition results in a long-term impairment.

12. Special Situations

12.1 Leave for Blood Donation

One (1) day of special paid leave per leave year on production of the donation certificate from a licensed blood bank or a recognised donation camp.

12.2 Leave for Elections

Paid time off on the day of a general election, State assembly election or local body election in the constituency in which the employee is registered, in accordance with Section 135B of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Where the polling day is not a Company holiday, employees are granted paid time off of not less than four (4) hours.

12.3 Leave for Jury or Statutory Duty

Paid time off for attendance at a court, tribunal or statutory authority in response to a summons, on production of the summons. Where the employee is a party to litigation against the Company, leave is applied against the Casual Leave or Earned Leave balance.

12.4 Leave for Sporting and Cultural Representation

Up to five (5) days of special paid leave per leave year for an employee selected to represent the State or the country in a recognised sporting or cultural event, on production of the selection letter from the recognised federation.

12.5 Quarantine and Public Health Directions

Where a public health authority directs an employee to isolate or quarantine, the period is treated as paid special leave and is not deducted from any leave balance, on production of the direction. Where the employee is able to work from home during the period, normal attendance applies and no leave is deducted.

12.6 Leave for Employees with Disabilities

An employee with a benchmark disability as certified under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, is entitled to an additional four (4) days of paid leave per leave year for medical review, therapy, assistive device fitting or related purposes. This entitlement is in addition to Sick Leave and does not require exhaustion of any other balance.

12.7 Gender Affirmation Leave

An employee undergoing gender affirmation treatment is entitled to up to thirty (30) days of paid special leave in a rolling twenty-four-month period, on medical certification. The application is handled directly by the CHRO's office, is not visible to the reporting manager on PeopleHub, and is recorded as Special Leave without further description.

13. Manager Responsibilities

A reporting manager is accountable for:

1. Acting on every leave request within two (2) working days.
2. Maintaining a team leave calendar that is visible to the whole team.
3. Ensuring that no more than 25% of a team is on planned leave in the same week, and that

critical-path roles have a named backup before leave begins.

4. Ensuring that every team member takes at least ten (10) days of Earned Leave in a leave year, including at least one block of five (5) continuous days.

5. Reviewing the monthly attendance exception report and closing exceptions within ten (10) working days.

6. Never asking a team member to work during approved leave. Contact during approved leave is permitted only for a Severity-1 incident and only through the formal recall procedure in Clause 5.5.

7. Raising Compensatory Off requests promptly for team members who work on a weekly off or a holiday at the manager's request.

Failure to discharge these responsibilities is assessed in the manager's own performance review under the "People Leadership" goal.

14. Reporting and Governance

14.1 Standard Reports

Report	Frequency	Audience
Leave balance and liability statement	Monthly	CFO, CHRO
Attendance exception register	Monthly	Function heads, HRBPs
Leave utilisation by function and band	Quarterly	Executive Leadership Team
High-balance alert (EL above 25 days)	Quarterly from 30 September	Managers, HRBPs
Absenteeism pattern report	Monthly	HRBPs
Statutory leave register (State-wise)	Annual	Labour authorities, on inspection
Sabbatical and extended absence register	Quarterly	CHRO

14.2 Policy Review

This Policy is reviewed annually by the Head of HR Operations, and is revised whenever there is a change in applicable law. Proposed revisions are consulted with the function heads and approved by the Executive Leadership Team.

14.3 Exceptions

An exception to any clause of this Policy requires the written approval of the CHRO, recorded on PeopleHub with the reason and the period of validity. Exceptions are reviewed by the Executive Leadership Team each quarter. No exception may reduce an entitlement below the statutory minimum.

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. My Casual Leave for the quarter is exhausted and I need a day off next week. What are my options? Apply for Earned Leave if you have an accrued balance. If not, you may apply for Loss of Pay with your manager's approval, or you may use a Compensatory Off if you hold one.

Q2. I fell ill on a day I had applied for Casual Leave. Can I convert it? Yes. Raise a modification request on PeopleHub within seven days of return, attaching the medical documentation if the absence exceeded two days.

Q3. Do weekends count against my Earned Leave? Only for absences of more than five continuous calendar days. For an absence of five days or fewer, intervening weekly offs and public holidays are not deducted.

Q4. I earned a Compensatory Off in March and it is now June. Can I still use it? No. Compensatory Off must be availed within sixty days of the date earned, after which it lapses. Your March credit expired in May.

Q5. Can I encash my Casual Leave when I leave the Company? No. Only Earned Leave, up to a maximum of thirty days, is encashable on separation.

Q6. I am a new father. How much leave do I get and when must I take it? Ten working days, in up to two blocks, taken within six months of the date of birth or the date of handover of an adopted child.

Q7. My manager has not acted on my leave request for four days. What happens? It escalates to your skip-level manager on day 3 and is auto-approved on day 5, unless it is a sabbatical, special leave, or a request for more than fifteen days.

Q8. I have 34 days of Earned Leave. What happens on 31 December? Thirty days carry forward. The remaining four days are encashed automatically in the January payroll at $(\text{Basic} + \text{DA}) \div 30$ per day, and the amount is taxable.

Q9. I am moving from Pune to Bengaluru for a six-month deputation. Whose holiday calendar applies? Bengaluru's, because the deputation exceeds thirty continuous days.

Q10. Independence Day 2026 falls on a Saturday. Do I get a compensatory day? No. A holiday falling on a weekly off is not compensated with an alternative day.

16. Annexure A — Leave Codes for Payroll and PeopleHub

Code	Description	Paid	Affects PF	Requires document
CL	Casual Leave	Yes	No	No
SL	Sick Leave	Yes	No	Above 2 days
EL	Earned Leave	Yes	No	No
CO	Compensatory Off	Yes	No	Manager request
ML	Maternity Leave	Yes	No	Yes
PL	Paternity Leave	Yes	No	Yes
AL	Adoption Leave	Yes	No	Yes
BL	Bereavement Leave	Yes	No	On request
MRL	Marriage Leave	Yes	No	Yes
SPL	Special Leave	As sanctioned	No	Yes
SAB	Sabbatical	No	Yes	Yes
LOP	Loss of Pay	No	Yes	No
ODC	On Duty — client site	Yes	No	Travel record
WFH	Work from home — approved day	Yes	No	No

17. Annexure B — Approval Matrix

Request	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3
CL, SL up to 2 days	Reporting manager	—	—
SL above 2 days	Reporting manager	HRBP (above 10 days)	—
EL up to 4 days	Reporting manager	—	—
EL 5 to 9 days	Reporting manager	Delivery Manager	—
EL 10 days and above	Reporting manager	Delivery Manager	HRBP
Compensatory Off	Reporting manager	—	—
Maternity, Paternity, Adoption	Reporting manager (informational)	HRBP	—
Marriage, Bereavement	Reporting manager	—	—
Sabbatical	Reporting manager	Function head	CHRO
Special Leave	HRBP	CHRO	—
Leave during notice period	Reporting manager	Function head	—
Leave recall	Delivery Manager	Band B6+ leader	—
Policy exception	HRBP	CHRO	—

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18. Annexure C — Document Control

Version	Date	Change
3.0	1 January 2022	Consolidated location addenda into a single policy
3.4	1 January 2023	Earned Leave raised from 15 to 18 days; carry-forward cap set at 30 days
4.0	1 January 2025	Auto-encashment of excess EL introduced; attendance bands revised
4.1	1 July 2025	Gender affirmation leave added; disability leave added
4.2	1 January 2026	Paternity Leave increased from 5 to 10 working days; Compensatory Off validity extended from 45 to 60 days; leave-decline restrictions added at Clause 10.2

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End of Document

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